



Denied!

Judge denies Samsung motion to stay Apple patent damages trial. Read more: http://dgit.in/de_nied



Crimson Dragon

Is Crimson Dragon the same as Panzer Dragoon, with a different name? Find out <http://dgit.in/crimd>

Digit Squad

Professionals from other sub-fields are required to have at least a basic understanding of all or most of other sub-fields. Jack of all trades and master of one is basically how it goes in InfoSec. Programmers can look into code auditing, writing vulnerability scanners and crypto applications.

Another major area is Penetration Testing or pentesting. The clichéd 'hacker' that you see in movies is actually a pentester. This is one of the most fun fields to get into if the idea of breaking into networks and having total control over all the machines and data of an organisation sounds good to you. Not only do you get to break into stuff but you also get paid for it. You also have to write reports, which many have publicly voiced their displeasure for. But it's no deal breaker.

InfoSec as a field is rapidly evolving, so simply popping root shells and getting domain admin (pentester terms for 'I own your machines and network', similar to gamer term 'totally pwned') isn't cool any-

more. You have to work towards making sure it doesn't happen this easily again, and when it does, the organization knows about it ASAP and should have a response team ready and procedures to follow to minimise impact. Things are never that simple though.

Reverse engineering(RE) involves taking apart a final product to find out how it works and in the process discover vulnerabilities that can be used to make the product do what you want it to do. Imagine taking apart a TV remote to find out that if you press particular four buttons at once, you can unlock any channel with parental lock. It is also used to discover hidden features in software that isn't entirely legitimate. Malware can be reverse engineered to find out how it communicates, what exactly it does once it is run. Imagine your housemaid making duplicates of all the keys to the house and selling them to someone else. This is how these 'clean your PC, you have 1337 Trojans' programs work. Reversing them

tells you what exactly happens behind that shady looking interface. A Botnet is such a network of malicious housemaids that have infected several thousand households or more. The infection is most severe when you don't even know you have a housemaid. Bad analogies aside, if you like taking stuff apart to find out how it works, RE is a brilliant field for you.

InfoSec is also a lot about giving back to the community. Be it research that you're making public or a tool that you are open sourcing or giving a talk at a conference. When it comes to defending against adversaries, if one finds an effective technique, they may share it with everyone. Same goes for attacks. O-day sales and disclosure practises are beyond the scope of this article but extremely interesting and relevant nonetheless.

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